

CYLAB SECURITY ACADEMY

Challenge Write-Up Template

Challenge Information

Student Name	Evallo, Daniella Kim N.
Section / Class	BSIT-3G
Challenge Name	bytemancy 0
Category	General Skills
Points / Difficulty	Easy
Date Solved	08/09/2026
Flag Format Given	PicoCTF{...}

1. Challenge Description

The challenge asked me to connect to a remote program using netcat and figure out what character I needed to enter. The program showed ASCII decimal 101 three times, and the characters had to be entered side-by-side with no spaces. The goal was to give the correct input and get the flag.

2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

I first checked the challenge instructions and looked at the value that was given. The important part was ASCII decimal 101. I checked what character that value represents and found that 101 is the lowercase letter 'e'. I also checked the provided Python source code. It compares the input with "\x65\x65\x65". Since hexadecimal 0x65 is also the letter 'e', this confirmed that the expected input was three e's.

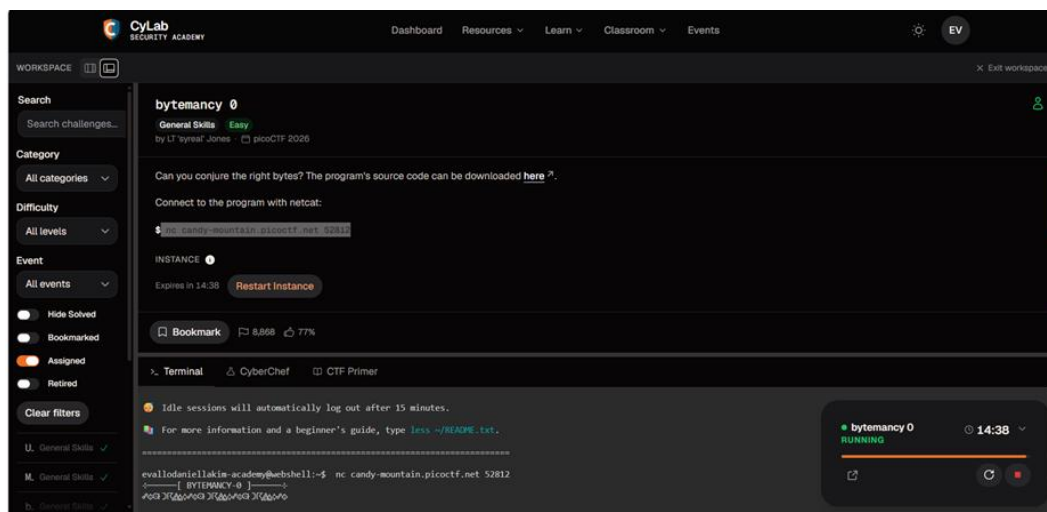
3. Tools and Commands Used

Tool / Command	What it was used for	Result / Output
Launch/ Restart Instance	Start or restart the bytemancy 0 challenge instance.	The challenge nstance became available.
nc candy-maountain.picoctf.net 52812	Connect to the remote bytemancy 0 challenges service.	The bytemancy 0 terminal opened
eee	Submit the required three lowercase e characters.	The input was accepted and the flag was returned.

4. Solution Walkthrough

Step 1

I opened the challenge in CyLab and started the instance. I checked the instructions first so I could understand what I needed to do. There was a command provided to connect to the program, so I used the **nc candy-mountain.picoctf.net 52812** before moving to the next step.



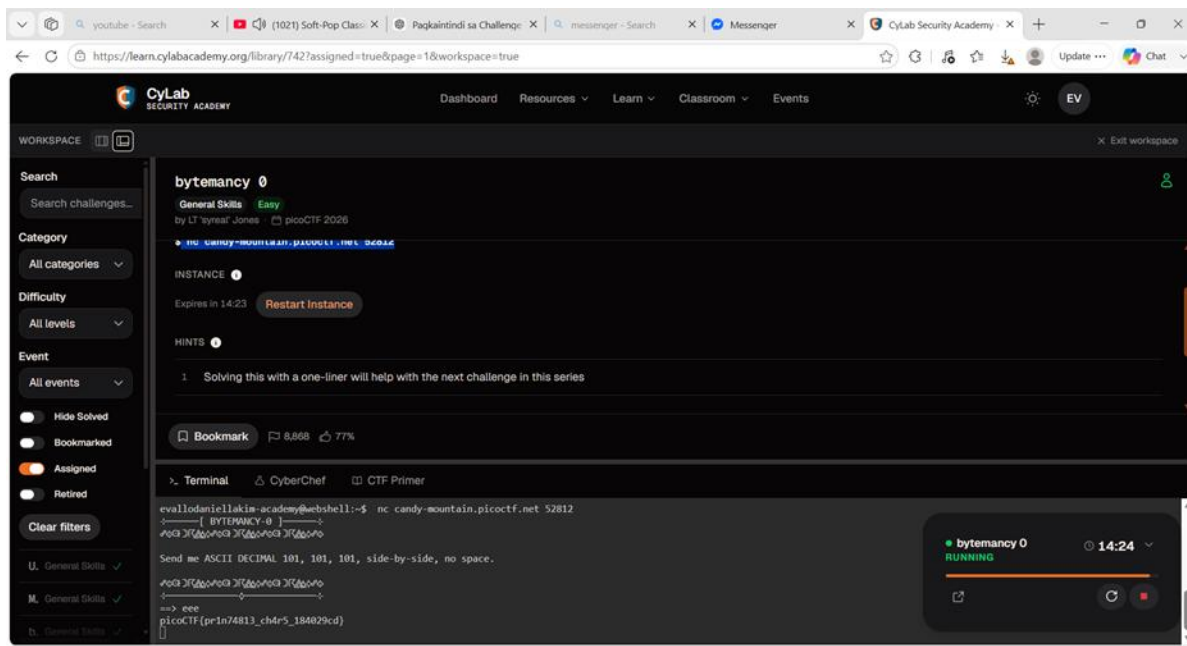
Step 2

I checked the provided Python source code before submitting the answer. The input check uses `"\x65\x65\x65"`, which is another way of writing three lowercase e characters. This matched the ASCII result, **"eee"**



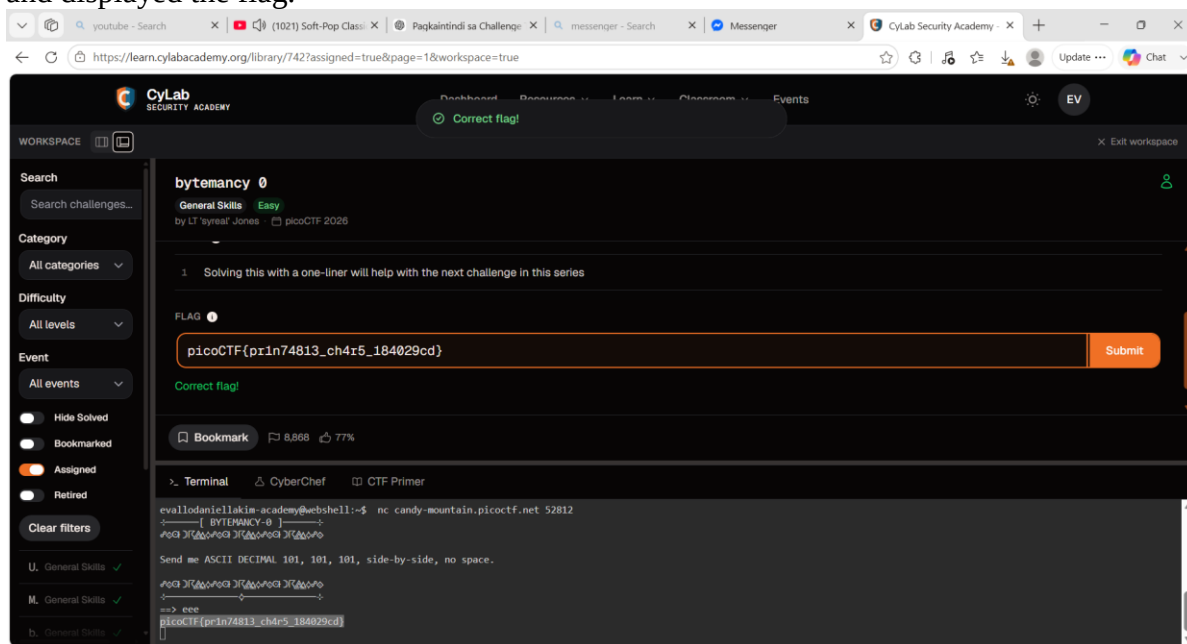
Step 3

I checked the challenge page and focused on the required input. It said to send ASCII decimal 101 three times, side-by-side and without spaces and ASCII decimal 101 is the lowercase letter 'e'. Since 101 was listed three times, the input should be **'eee'**.



Step 4

I used the netcat command given by the challenge, then entered 'eee'. The server accepted the input and displayed the flag.



5. Flag

picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_184029cd}

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

This challenge helped me understand how ASCII values can represent normal characters. I also practiced using netcat to connect to a remote service. The main thing I learned was that decimal 101 and hexadecimal 0x65 both represent the letter 'e'.

7. References

[picoCTF 2026 | Denton's Blog](#)
